YARED GEBREMICHAEL DEBELA

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

MEAL and Program Quality specialist with 18 years in international NGOs and donor agencies across East and Southern Africa. Has built and run MEAL systems for USAID-, USDOS-, PEPFAR-, Irish Aid- and DFID-funded programs, from emergency cholera and WASH response to OVC care and national health information systems. Works in qualitative and quantitative research, digital data collection, DHIS2, and GIS-based analysis. Has trained more than 200 M&E professionals and led baselines, mid-term reviews, and final evaluations. Experienced with USAID reporting and PEPFAR indicators.

CORE COMPETENCIES

- **MEAL strategy and systems:** framework design, indicator development, performance monitoring plans
- **Evaluation and assessment:** baselines, mid-term and final evaluations, cash and market assessments, post-distribution monitoring, data quality assessments
- **Data and analytics:** DHIS2, DATIM, SPSS, Tableau, ArcGIS, CommCare, iFormBuilder
- **ICT4D and GIS:** digital MEAL systems, mobile data collection, spatial analysis
- **Protection and accountability:** beneficiary feedback mechanisms, safeguarding, CHS and GDPR compliance
- **Capacity building, knowledge management, and stakeholder coordination**

PROFESSIONAL EXPERIENCE

Samaritan's Purse, Lebanon (Middle East Programs)

July 2026 – Present

Faith-based international relief organization. Programs include USDOS-funded WASH, Nutrition, and FSL initiatives.

Monitoring and Evaluation Manager

- Run the MEAL system across Middle East programs, including the USDOS-funded Lebanon Emergency Response Program (LERP). Work with program staff, partners, and consultants on design, monitoring, and reporting, and brief management and donors on progress.
- Administer the regional reporting platforms. Train leadership and field staff on data collection software and M&E practice.
- Design M&E strategies for field programs that meet USDOS, SPHERE, WHO, and organizational standards. Contribute to proposals and results frameworks.
- Provide roving support and training to staff and partners. Run rapid needs assessments, baselines, and evaluations using standardized methodologies.
- Maintain project databases and run spot checks on outputs and impact. Compile lessons learned and feed them into program decisions and donor reports.

HelpAge International

November 2025 – June 2026

Global network of organizations working for the wellbeing, dignity, and voice of older people.

Global Capacity Building and MEAL Officer, SCORE Program

- Designed and harmonized global MEAL frameworks and digital tools so country offices collect and report data to a common standard.
- Built accountability mechanisms and safeguarding procedures aligned with the Core Humanitarian Standard (CHS) and GDPR.
- Trained and mentored national staff and partners on Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability, and Learning (PMEAL).
- Led program evaluations and learning reviews that informed adaptive management and gave country teams evidence for advocacy.

USAID Ethiopia April 2024 – August 2025

U.S. government agency for international development and humanitarian assistance.

Strategic Information (SI) Cluster Lead, Health Office

- Oversaw data collection, validation, and analysis for USAID Ethiopia's health portfolio, so that program planning rested on accurate, timely data.
- Led M&E work to assess program impact, find performance gaps, and refine interventions.
- Coordinated implementing partners' performance reports to meet USAID and donor requirements.
- Built working relationships with government agencies, implementing partners, and donors to improve data sharing.
- Gave technical assistance and training on data quality and the use of evidence in decisions.

Johanniter International Assistance, Mozambique March 2023 – April 2024

Humanitarian arm of Johanniter, providing medical services, disaster relief, and international aid. Funders: USAID, GFFO, BMZ, OFDA/BHA. Sectors: WASH, Nutrition, FSL.

Head of Planning, Monitoring, Evaluation, Accountability and Learning (PMEAL)

- Developed and implemented the Mozambique PMEAL strategy in line with Johanniter's global strategy and donor requirements, working with the Strategy and Learning team and national program teams.
- Coordinated the Mozambique country strategy with HQ so that it matched Johanniter's global objectives.
- Designed and rolled out national PMEAL frameworks with country office teams and HQ-based PMEAL advisors.
- Used program data to support adaptive management and the delivery of strategic program objectives.
- Set up reporting and coordination routines between HQ and the country office to improve transparency and mutual accountability.

Samaritan's Purse, South Sudan March 2021 – February 2023

Funder: USAID OFDA/BHA. Sectors: WASH, Nutrition, FSL.

Monitoring and Evaluation Training Coordinator

- Supported the MEAL system in South Sudan with M&E staff, consultants, and stakeholders. Gave regular progress updates to donors and the National M&E Program Manager.
- Administered the Samaritan's Purse Reporting System (SPRS) in-country. Trained and supported M&E staff, Program Managers, and other personnel on data collection software.
- Designed and implemented M&E strategies so that program activities and results met UNHCR, WHO, and organizational standards.
- Trained program and M&E field staff to run rapid needs assessments, baselines, evaluations, and surveys using standardized methodologies.
- Trained M&E and program staff on Mobile Data Collection (MDC), covering iFormBuilder and SPRS for project monitoring and data management.

Trócaire, CAFOD, SCIAF (CST), Ethiopia May 2019 – February 2021

Joint program funded by Irish Aid, DFID, UKAID, and the Humanitarian Response Fund (HRF).

Country Monitoring, Evaluation and Learning Advisor

- Led all MEL components of the contract, including the MEL process and system, for the CST country program and SCORE project partners.
- Set the direction for knowledge management and research.
- Developed and introduced MEL tools adapted to Ethiopia's humanitarian context.
- Led evaluations and assessments, setting indicators, baselines, and results frameworks. Work covered cash and market assessments, post-distribution monitoring, mid-term reviews, and terminal evaluations.

Catholic Relief Services (CRS), South Sudan November 2017 – February 2019

International humanitarian and development agency with over 1,000 employees in four states and $170 million in funding from USAID, DFID, and UNICEF.

MEAL Manager I, USAID BHA/OFDA Emergency Cholera Response *(international position)*

- Set the strategic direction for the country program's MEAL policies and procedures, and built systems for accountability to beneficiaries, donors, and stakeholders.

- Established and ran the MEAL system, reporting progress against OFDA indicators and tracking program quality and participant outcomes.
- Developed accountability and beneficiary feedback mechanisms to protect beneficiaries and make sure their needs were addressed.
- Coordinated with WASH, Livelihood, and Nutrition programs, and standardized activities and tools where possible.
- Supervised 5 M&E and 23 program staff in the field to put the right plans and tools in place in each operational area.
- Trained staff in participatory and qualitative approaches and in building monitoring plans that capture quantitative and qualitative data against project targets.

Catholic Relief Services (CRS), Ethiopia July 2011 – October 2017

Over 300 employees and $200 million in funding from USAID, UNOCHA, and MWI (Coca-Cola, Hilton, KGM).

Manager, Country Monitoring and Evaluation, ICT4D *(national position)*

Led the rollout of a humanitarian information system, supported the Output Tracker, and integrated ICT4D initiatives across partners.

- Designed and managed projects and shared MEAL findings in time to inform decisions, in line with CRS Ethiopia's strategy.
- Coordinated ICT4D projects with partners under CRS's system development life cycle (SDLC), delivering within budget and on schedule.
- Collected and analyzed digital program data on service delivery and beneficiaries.
- Supported MEAL staff in project evaluations to document lessons and raise program quality.
- Facilitated cross-country learning and reflection sessions to improve project performance.
- Worked with partners to apply evaluation results in decisions and to identify good practices.

Salesian Missions (Don Bosco), USAID/PEPFAR, Ethiopia June 2009 – July 2011

CARING for our Youth: a $10 million PEPFAR/USAID-funded OVC care and support project in Addis Ababa, Debre Zeit, Zeway, Adami Tulu, Mekelle, Adwa, and Adigrat.

Coordinator, Monitoring and Evaluation

- Developed and managed the project's Performance Monitoring Plan (PMP) and the systems for tracking inputs, outputs, outcomes, and impact.
- Coordinated monitoring, evaluation, and reporting under the PEPFAR/USAID award.
- Made supportive supervisory visits to implementing partners. Gave feedback on data and indicator use, analyzed monthly data, and trained partner M&E staff in quality assurance.
- Designed the methodology for baselines, midterm, and end-of-term evaluations, and organized them with partner M&E and project management staff.
- Led field tests of the M&E system and coordinated data quality assessments, with revisions made as implementation continued.
- Built the project database and equipped partner M&E staff to use it in their offices.

Beza Lehiwot Ethiopia June 2006 – February 2009

Local NGO with 30 employees and hundreds of community volunteers. Donors: USAID, FHI360, Save the Children, Royal Netherlands Embassy. Projects: PC3 (Positive Change, Children, Communities and Care) and Our Father's Kitchen.

Program Officer

- Linked orphans and vulnerable children (OVC) to the services they were eligible for, directly or through networks with relevant stakeholders, and supported smooth transitions between services.
- Supported caregivers to improve the welfare of the children in their care.

Ministry of Health, Mugher Cement Enterprise Clinic, Ethiopia September 2001 – May 2006

Government health institution with over 100 employees, providing community clinical care.

Community Nurse

- Worked with medical providers, primary care teams, and social services agencies under indirect supervision. Coordinated short-term care and connected clients to resources.

- Gave health education to support client health and wellbeing.

VOLUNTEER EXPERIENCE

Family Health International (FHI360), USAID/PEPFAR 2009 (3 months)

Community Volunteer

Volunteered in home-based care for people living with HIV at Beza Lehiwot Community Based Organization, Addis Ababa, with 100 community volunteers on the USG/FHI360-funded PC3 Project.

KEY ACHIEVEMENTS

- Led development of the national M&E strategy for USAID Ethiopia, strengthening data quality and program effectiveness.
- Designed a GIS-based tracking system for health interventions that cut data discrepancies by 40%.
- Trained 200+ M&E professionals across INGOs in East and Southern Africa.
- Integrated ICT4D tools into monitoring and reporting for multi-country projects.

SELECTED PROJECTS

- **Title II, USAID Joint Emergency Operation ($100M, 2014–2017):** Built three digital MEAL systems, still in use: Climate Early Warning and Disaster Preparedness; Risk and Compliance Management for Food Monitoring; GIS for Program Management.
- **South Sudan USAID BHA Emergency WASH ($5M, 2017–2019):** Built an emergency MEAL system to improve field-level data collection. Designed and ran baseline and end-line evaluations. Set up a Community Help Desk (CHM) for beneficiary feedback and response.
- **IAPG II, Irish Aid Mid-Term Evaluation and Humanitarian Project Plan (HPP) ($8M, 2019–2022):** Conducted the Mid-Term Review of the Ethiopian Women's Empowerment Program under Irish Aid's International NGO Program Grant (IAPG).

EDUCATION

Institution	Degree	Year
Sikkim Manipal University (India)	**MBA, Project Management**	2011
Addis Ababa University (Ethiopia)	**BSc, Information Systems**	2007
Addis Ababa University (Ethiopia)	**Associate Degree, Community Health Science (Nursing)**	2000

ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

- **Geographic experience:** Long-term: Ethiopia, South Sudan, Mozambique. Short-term assignments: Kenya, Rwanda, Ghana.
- **Languages:** Amharic (native), English (strong working proficiency).
- **Technical skills (all advanced):** Microsoft Office, Gen AI tools, SPSS, DHIS2, DATIM, Tableau, ArcGIS, Adobe Suite, CommCare, iFormBuilder.

Working style

- **Leadership:** Manages and mentors field and country teams to a clear quality standard.
- **Analysis:** Starts from the data, finds the gap, and proposes a fix.
- **Participation and inclusion:** Applies gender equality, cultural sensitivity, and participatory approaches in program design and evaluation.
- **Learning:** Uses appreciative inquiry and evaluative thinking to improve programs over time.

Certifications and training

- Applied Performance Evaluation, Frankfurt, Germany (July 2024)

- MEAL DPro Certification (October 2022)
- GDPR Certification (2022)
- Safeguarding and Protection of Beneficiaries and Staff (2021)
- MEAL Framework Development, Prague, Czechia (July 2019)
- Knowledge Management Professional Certification, KMPCC (2016)
- PM4Dev, PMD Pro, Project Management Professional (2016)
- Evaluative Thinking I, II and III, CRS, Addis Ababa (2016)
- MEAL Practice and Policy, CRS, Nairobi (2015)
- GIS and Spatial Analysis with ArcGIS (2015)
- ProPack I, II, III and SMILER M&E System, CRS, Nairobi (April 2012)
- Project Cycle Management and M&E, PCI (2010)
- Presenter at MEAL and ICT4D conferences in Hyderabad (India), Kigali (Rwanda), Accra (Ghana), and Nairobi (Kenya)

REFERENCES

Available on request.